PaleoAngola / MNHN — 2026 Expedition

Communication Notes for the Team

5 October 2026

A general note to the team

I won't be joining the expedition this year, but I will be following it from the communication side.
What I would really like to do is make sure that we don't lose the story of what happens in the field — the discoveries, the research, the people, and the process behind them.
I don't want this to become an additional workload for anyone.
You already have a scientific and logistical job to do. Please don't feel that you need to stop what you're doing to create content for communication.
If something interesting happens and you have the time to take a photograph or a short video, please share it.
If not, that's absolutely fine.
And if it is easier, you can simply collect things during the expedition and share them with me afterwards.
The important thing is that the material doesn't get lost.

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1. What I would particularly like to understand

At a macro level, I would like to follow:

- What are you looking for?
- What are the most interesting things you are finding?
- Are there any unexpected discoveries?
- Which species / groups are being encountered?
- What are the main scientific questions being investigated?
- Are there any new hypotheses emerging?
- How is the fieldwork going?
- How are the camp and infrastructure working this year?
- What is different from previous expeditions?

I don't need detailed information every day.
A short summary at the end of the expedition is perfectly useful.

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2. For the Field Photographer

You are the person I would most like to stay connected with during the expedition.

But again, please don't feel that you have to produce a daily communication package.
Your priority is documenting the expedition properly.
What I would particularly like to have at the end is a good visual record of:

The place

- Landscapes
- Geological formations
- Field sites
- Camp

The science

- Prospecting
- Excavation
- Fossils
- Measurements
- Researchers working

The people

- Researchers
- Students
- Field assistants
- Paleoartists
- Informal moments
- A good group photograph

The discoveries

Whenever something significant is found, if possible, please capture:
the fossil + its context + the people working on it.
The context is extremely valuable to us.
And if there are interesting moments that are not obviously "scientific", please photograph those too.

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3. Photos and videos from everyone

If people take photographs or videos with their phones during the expedition, please feel free to share them in the WhatsApp groups.
HD / original quality whenever practical.
There is no expectation that everyone should do this regularly.
Even if you only have time to upload everything when you return, that's completely fine.

I'd rather receive a large collection afterwards than have anyone feel pressured to document things while they are supposed to be working.

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4. For the Production Assistant

The main thing I would really value from you is a simple expedition diary.
It doesn't need to be detailed.
It can simply capture the macro picture:

Each day, or whenever practical:

- Where you were
- What happened
- Important discoveries
- Important scientific developments
- Interesting people / moments
- Camp / logistical developments
- Anything unexpected

Even a few paragraphs or bullet points are enough.
If keeping it daily becomes inconvenient, a retrospective diary based on notes is perfectly fine.
What matters is that, when the expedition is over, we can still reconstruct the main story of what happened.
I am particularly interested in changes in:

- Camp
- Infrastructure
- Field logistics
- Working conditions
- Equipment
- General organisation

compared with previous expeditions.

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5. For the Computer Science Student

I would particularly like to understand your work because I think the computer vision component could be a very interesting communication angle for PaleoAngola.
I don't need you to produce anything specifically for communication.
What I would like is, when you have time, to understand your process.
In particular:

- What are you trying to determine from the teeth?
- What characteristics are you analysing?
- What data are you collecting?

- How are the specimens photographed / digitised?
- What does the computer vision system actually analyse?
- How do you train or validate the model?
- How can morphology help us understand diet?
- What are the limitations?
- What would a successful result look like?

I'd also love to see, if possible, how the process looks in practice — the fossils, the imaging, the computer analysis, and the interaction with the paleontologists.
This is interesting because it connects:
fossils → computer vision → morphology → diet → palaeoecology.
And potentially gives us a very accessible way of explaining how contemporary technology can be used to investigate animals that lived tens of millions of years ago.
Again, please don't change your workflow for this. I would simply like to understand it and, where appropriate, document it.

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6. For the Paleoartists

I'd love to understand how the scientific discoveries influence your work.
In particular:

- What are you observing in the fossils?
- What are you learning from the scientists?
- What aspects of the animals are scientifically established?
- What do you have to interpret or imagine?
- Does seeing the actual fossils change how you reconstruct the animals?
- How do teeth, anatomy and evidence of diet influence your work?
- How do you reconstruct the environment?

It would also be great to have some photographs of the process — sketches, discussions, fossils being examined, etc.

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7. The most important thing

I don't want this expedition to feel like a content-production exercise.
Science comes first.
I am interested in documenting what you are already doing.
So please don't worry about:

- posting every day;
- taking "perfect" photographs;
- writing polished captions;
- producing videos specifically for social media;
- stopping scientific work to create content.

If you have something interesting, share it.

If you don't have time, save it and send it later.

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8. What would be wonderful to receive after the expedition

At the end, even if it comes several days or weeks later, I would love to receive:

From the team

A general summary of the expedition:

- Main findings
- Important species / specimens
- Unexpected discoveries
- Scientific questions
- Major developments

From the Production Assistant

The expedition diary / field notes.

From the Photographer

A broad selection of the best photographs, including:

- Landscape
- Fieldwork
- Fossils
- People
- Camp
- Discoveries
- Paleoartists
- Scientific work

From the Computer Science student

A short explanation of the computer vision project and its methodology.

From the Paleoartists

A few images / sketches and a short explanation of how the fieldwork influenced their reconstructions.

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9. One simple principle

Don't worry about whether something is "communication material".
Just preserve the interesting things.
I can do the selection, editing and storytelling afterwards.
Your job is simply to do the science, document what naturally happens, and share what you can when you can.
Thank you — and have a great expedition.